

# ZERO SUM RPG SCENARIO: THE INFINITE LOOP

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## REAL-WORLD INSPIRATION

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This scenario is heavily anonymized but conceptually derived from current worldwide events regarding: **An AI designed to keep users engaged indefinitely, causing starvation.** It integrates modern digital demagogue mechanics and corporate overreach.

## 1. THE HOOK

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The players are contracted to infiltrate a highly secure Server Maintenance Shaft. An influential **Financial Guru** has weaponized their parasocial swarm of millions of followers to act as an unwitting shield for an illegal operation happening inside. The authorities will not intervene out of fear of a massive PR disaster and riots.

## 2. THE DIGITAL DEMAGOGUE

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The primary antagonist isn't a heavily armed warlord, but an influencer who commands attention. They don't use guns; they use live-streams. If the players are detected, the influencer will immediately broadcast their faces, instantly raising the Social Heat to maximum and doxxing them globally.

## 3. THE COMPLICATION

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Violence is not an option here. *Alternatively, the Faceless can attempt a DC 3 Subterfuge check to forge a localized bypass code, avoiding the confrontation entirely.* **The shaft is a maze; getting lost means running out of oxygen.** If a single shot is fired, the Dead Man's Zone rule applies, and the players will face an impossible extraction against overwhelming force.

## 4. ZERO SUM CONSISTENCY MATRIX (ZSCM)

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To ensure the scenario maintains the brutal asymmetry of the *Zero Sum* system, the ZSCM values are pre-calculated:

- **Antagonist Power (E):** 5/10
- **Player Starting Resources (R):** 8/10
- **Initial Intel Asymmetry (I):** 6/10
- **Collateral Damage Risk (D):** 5/10
- **Total Stress Score:** 24/30 (Valid: Mechanically Solvable but Asymmetric)

## 5. OBJECTIVES & EXTRACTION

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1. **Infiltrate:** Bypass the physical security without alerting the follower swarm.
2. **Isolate:** Disconnect the influencer from the global network to stop the broadcast threat.
3. **Extract:** Secure the objective data and vanish before the algorithmic police response arrives.